Developmental Psychology - Structural Correspondence with the 5-Stage Model

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Contents

Developmental Psychology . . . 1
Survey Overview . . . 1
Overview of the 5-Stage Model . . . 1
Overview of Structural Correspondences . . . 2
Key Entry 1: Kegan's Constructive-Developmental Theory . . . 4
Key Entry 2: Thelen & Smith's Dynamic Systems Approach . . . 4
Key Entry 3: Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development . . . 4
Cross-Cutting Patterns . . . 5
Unresolved Questions . . . 5
Conclusion . . . 5

Developmental Psychology

Structural correspondence survey with the 5-stage model (Ba / Wave / En / Uzu / Taba)

Survey Overview

- **Survey target**: 15 major theories in developmental psychology
- **Research question**: Do the various theories of developmental psychology correspond structurally to the 5-stage model?
- **Results**: Strong correspondence in 2 cases, conditional correspondence in 1 case

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Overview of the 5-Stage Model

Stage	Definition
Ba (Field)	An undifferentiated state. The initial condition in which no direction or structure has yet been established
Wave	The exploratory stage in which multiple directions diverge and compete
En (Edge)	A state of tension in which opposing elements coexist without converging on either side. The place where they meet at the boundary, influence each other, and relationships emerge
Uzu (Vortex)	The stage in which a new coherence (order) arises spontaneously from within the tension
Taba (Bundle)	The stage in which the form is fixed and stabilizes as a reusable structure

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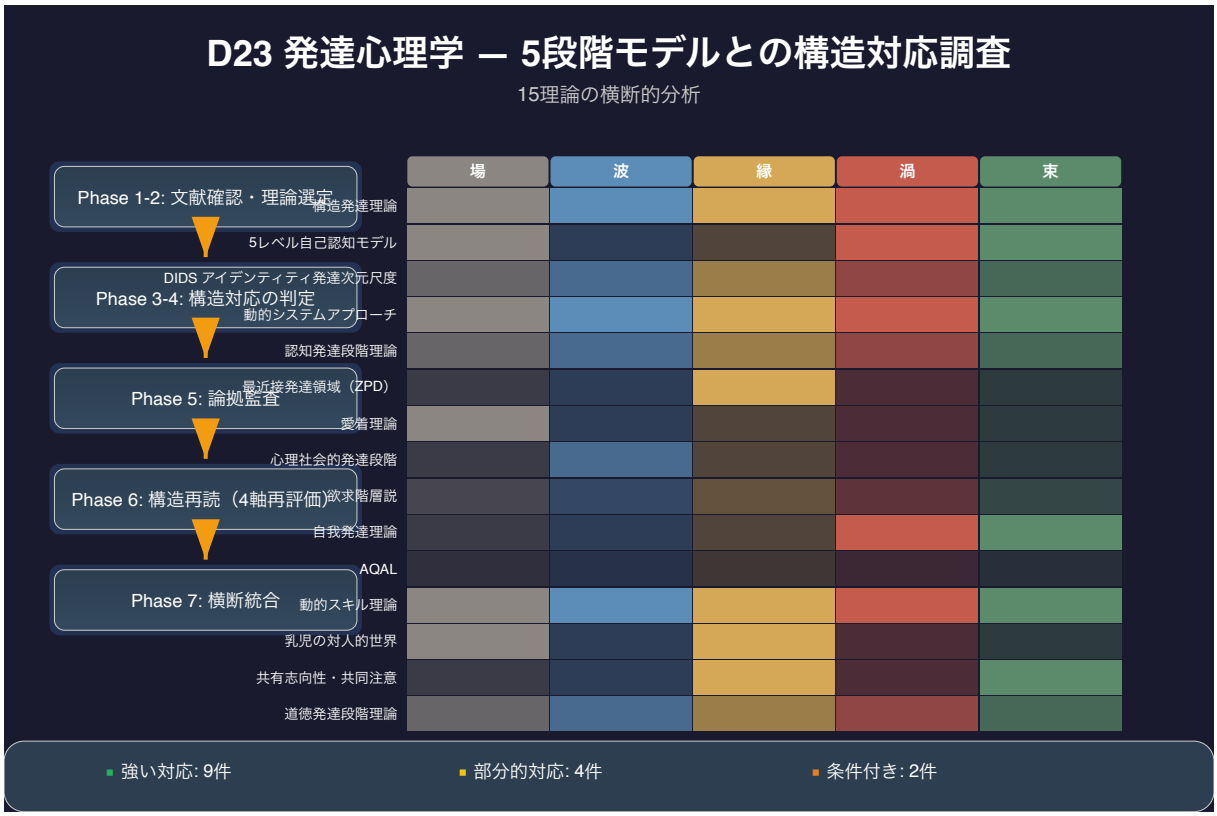

Figure 1: Domain — Research Overview Infographic

Overview of Structural Correspondences

Confidence	Theory group	Positioning
Near-established	Kegan, Thelen & Smith's dynamic systems, Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development, Fischer's dynamic skill theory, Tomasello's shared intentionality	The description of transitions is concrete, and En→Uzu→Taba is clearly delineated
Compelling	Rochat's self-awareness model, Bowlby's attachment theory, Stern's development of the sense of self, Cook-Greuter's ego development theory, DIDS's identity cycling model	Correspondence exists but compression or parallelism remains in the earlier or later stages
Conditional	Piaget, Erikson, Kohlberg, Maslow	Partial correspondence exists, but the center of the theory does not lie in the full generative process of all 5 stages
Audit frame	AQAL (a meta-theory integrating multiple perspectives)	Rather than claiming direct correspondence, it is more useful as a framework for checking gaps or overgeneralizations in comparison

15発達心理学理論と5段階モデルの対応関係マトリクス

	場 (Field)	波 (Wave)	縁 (Edge)	渦 (Vortex)	束 (Bundle)
1. 構造発達理論	-	-	-	-	-
2. 5レベル自己認知モデル	場	-	-	渦	束
3. DIDS アイデンティティ発達次元尺度	-	-	-	-	-
4. 動的システムアプローチ	-	-	-	-	-
5. 認知発達段階理論	-	-	-	-	-
6. 最近接発達領域（ZPD）	-	-	縁	-	-
7. 愛着理論	場	-	-	-	-
8. 心理社会的発達段階	-	波	-	-	-
9. 欲求階層説	-	-	-	-	-
10. 自我発達理論	-	-	-	渦	束
11. AQAL	-	-	-	-	-
12. 動的スキル理論	-	-	-	-	-
13. 乳児の対人的世界	場	-	縁	-	-
14. 共有志向性・共同注意	-	-	縁	-	束
15. 道徳発達段階理論	-	-	-	-	-

凡例 (Legend)

強い対応 (Strong)　部分的 (Partial)　条件付き/弱い (Conditional/Weak)

Figure 2: Domain — Theory x 5-Stage Correspondence Matrix

Key Entry 1: Kegan's Constructive-Developmental Theory

- Kegan described development as a transformation in which "what was subject becomes object." The assumptions that drove a person at one stage become the subject of revision at the next. It is a theory widely referenced in adult development research, dealing with the increasing complexity of meaning-making.
- The strongest correspondence with the 5 stages is in En→Uzu→Taba. The stage in which the self is shaped within a web of interpersonal relationships reads as close to En; the stage in which the self's own standards and value system arise as a coherent whole reads as close to Uzu; and the stage in which one can relativize that coherence itself and hold multiple perspectives reads as close to Taba. Conversely, placing Ba and Wave directly at the initial stages risks compressing them too much into infancy or drive stages, so the correspondence with the first half requires careful handling.
- For example, the change in which a person whose criterion for judgment was acceptance by others comes to articulate their own value standards and can then reorganize relationships while maintaining those standards concretely illustrates the transition from En to Uzu.
- What makes this theory important is that it describes development not as "an increase in content" but as "a change in structure." In the 5-stage model as well, what matters is not the number of elements but the reorganization of perspective. In this sense, Kegan is one of the theories that most clearly shows the skeleton of the latter three stages.

Key Entry 2: Thelen & Smith's Dynamic Systems Approach

- Thelen and Smith viewed development not as the passage through fixed stages but as the self-organization of a multi-variable system. Well known for their reinterpretation of infant stepping reflexes and the A-not-B task, they explain development using the vocabulary of stable states, destabilization, phase transitions, and new stabilization.
- This theory is the most consistently supportive auxiliary line for all 5 stages. Reading the current stable state as Ba, turbulence and destabilization as Wave, the vicinity of the phase transition where multiple patterns compete as En, the establishment of a new coordinative pattern as Uzu, and the consolidation of that pattern as Taba, each phase connects naturally. Particularly important is the fact that En can be explained not as a "boundary line" but as "the vicinity of a phase transition where competition coexists."
- However, this theory alone is insufficient to describe what Taba leaves behind as narrative, norms, or institutions. Dynamic systems theory is strong on the dynamics of transition, and the social depth of residual structure needs to be supplemented by other theories.

Key Entry 3: Vygotsky's Zone of Proximal Development

- Vygotsky viewed development not as individual inner maturation but as internalization through social interaction with others. The zone of proximal development is the domain in which what cannot be done independently becomes possible with support. It is a theory widely used in research on education and learning.
- The correspondence with the 5 stages shows En→Uzu→Taba as extremely strong. The phase in which competence temporarily comes into being in the context of joint activity with a teacher or others is En; the phase in which the structure of support transforms into internal regulatory capacity is Uzu; and the phase in which one can reproduce the outcome even without support is Taba. For example, the process in which a task that could only be solved with guidance comes to be solvable independently directly illustrates this chain.
- On the other hand, Ba in this theory is already a socially organized field. Rather than an undifferentiated starting point, it is a Ba in which support relationships and cultural tools are already in place. Therefore, it is more accurate to read this theory not as one that explains the first half of the 5 stages, but rather as a theory that explains what is generated within relationships and how it persists.

Cross-Cutting Patterns

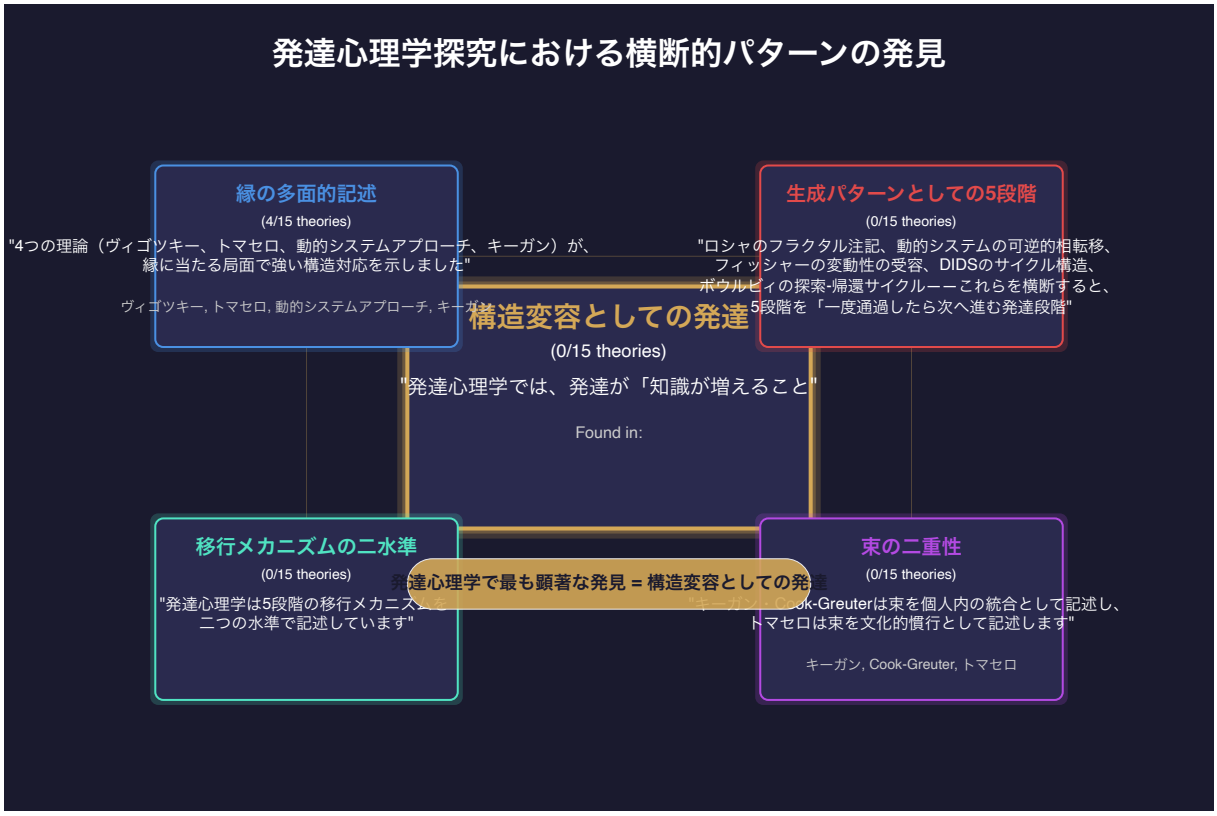

Figure 3: Domain — Cross-Cutting Patterns Diagram

- The pattern that recurs most frequently across developmental psychology is the thickness of En→Uzu
- Second, the understanding of Ba is revised
- Third, the criteria for Taba are also narrowed
- Fourth, strong correspondence is not determined by the number of stages

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Unresolved Questions

- Whether the minimum unit of En is sufficient as a dyadic relationship, or whether it should include triadic relationships as Tomasello suggests, has not yet been resolved.
- When Ba is read as a pre-structure such as a safe base or support conditions, how far the understanding of Ba as undifferentiated can be maintained requires future clarification.
- Depending on whether Taba is read as stability within the individual or as including structures externalized into culture and institutions, the scope of the latter three stages changes.
- How to compare cyclic models like DIDS, theories of overlapping senses of self like Stern's, and theories of life-long tasks like Erikson's with the linear five phases is a methodological challenge that remains.

Conclusion

- This survey confirmed that developmental psychology is a domain with overall compelling structural similarity to the 5-stage model
- Near-established are the lineages of Kegan, Thelen & Smith, Vygotsky, Fischer, and Tomasello
- Therefore, the greatest insight to be gained from developmental psychology is that the core of creation and structural change lies not so much in the interior of a completed individual but in generation within relationships and its persistence